

Startup Operational Excellence

A Practical Mentor Guide for Building a Business with its Own Soul

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This book provides general business education and operational guidance. It is not legal, financial, tax, investment, or compliance advice. Founders should consult qualified professionals for decisions that require licensed judgment.

Disclosure Notes

The founder scenes in this book use Sam as a composite character. They are designed to teach practical lessons without exposing private client details.

This book was developed with AI-assisted drafting and editing under Robert T. McCarthy's direction. The ideas, judgment, voice, final editorial decisions, and responsibility for the work remain with the author.

Some graphics or visual aids in this book may be AI-assisted. They are used to clarify concepts, not to represent real clients, private business records, or documented case results unless explicitly stated.

How To Use This Book

This book is meant to be read like a mentor conversation and used like a field

guide.

You do not have to fix everything at once. In fact, trying to fix everything at once is one of the ways founders stay stuck. Read for clarity first. Mark the places where your business feels familiar. When a chapter gives you a checkpoint, choose one visible improvement and make that improvement real. The appendices at the back are not homework for perfectionists. They are tools for founders who need a place to start. Use them when the story names a problem you recognize and you are ready to turn that recognition into action.

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